

Toothache - Male (Adult)

Algorithm 1309 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Male

Definition

- Toothache assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published toothache guidance.
- Adult patient.
- Male.

Initial assessment

1. [OPEN_TEXT] Which tooth, and how long has it hurt?
2. [YES_NO] Any facial or neck swelling, or fever?
3. [PAIN_SCALE] How severe is the pain, 0-10?
4. [OPEN_TEXT] Record age, pregnancy, immune suppression, diabetes, anticoagulants, medicines and doses already taken, poor intake, trauma, and safeguarding concern.

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Mouth Ulcers

Are shallow sores or ulcers inside the mouth the main concern rather than pain arising from a tooth?

Mouth sores without a primary tooth problem belong in the Mouth Ulcers pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Is the area around the eye or neck swollen, or is swelling in the mouth or neck making it difficult to breathe, swallow, or speak?

NHS.UK toothache guidance lists spreading facial/neck swelling with airway or swallowing difficulty as an immediate emergency (a dental abscess can spread rapidly). Do not drive yourself to the emergency department.

1. Disposition level 70

Has the pain lasted more than 2 days, does it not go away with painkillers, or is there fever, biting pain, red gums, a bad taste, or cheek/jaw swelling?

NHS.UK guidance recommends contacting a dentist for these persistent or infection-suggestive symptoms.

1. Disposition level 15

Is this mild, recent tooth pain with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance describes mild, recent toothache as manageable at home while awaiting a routine dental appointment.

Advice

Emergency dental-infection precautions

- Call Qatar 999 now for airway, swallowing, eye or neck swelling and do not allow self-driving. Sit upright if breathing is easier, give nothing by mouth if swallowing is unsafe, and do not squeeze or pierce swelling. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: worsening swelling, drooling, breathing difficulty, confusion, or collapse.

Prompt dental assessment

- Use the Qatar governance-approved emergency-dental pathway. Do not use leftover antibiotics or place aspirin or caustic products on the gum. Medication requires age, pregnancy, allergy, kidney/liver disease, anticoagulant, and dose checks.
- Call Back If: swelling, fever, trismus, poor intake, or worsening pain.

Temporary low-risk toothache care

- Use soft foods, avoid temperature triggers, and rinse gently with warm salt water only if old enough to spit safely. Confirm all pain medicines and oral gels with a dentist or pharmacist; do not delay definitive dental care.
- Call Back If: pain persists, fever, swelling, poor intake, swallowing or breathing difficulty.

First aid

- Call Qatar 999 now for airway, swallowing, eye or neck swelling and do not allow self-driving. Sit upright if breathing is easier, give nothing by mouth if swallowing is unsafe, and do not squeeze or pierce swelling. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Toothache", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/toothache/> (page last reviewed 01 July 2024)

Provenance

Shaped to mirror the licensed After-Hours Telehealth Triage Guidelines database structure. This is IST open-source guideline content derived from cited public sources; it is not licensed STCC content. Question.DispositionLevel=null marks a See More Appropriate Guideline

redirect. Demographic variants contain only source-supported differences; identical thresholds are documented rather than fabricated. Local destinations and TelemedicineEligible values require IST clinical governance approval. UAT DATA ONLY - NOT FOR REAL-PATIENT CARE OR PRODUCTION USE.

Manifest hash: 1d56145753f6cc39871edb657fd9b69148221d6f36b1dbdd30dc2ac0fb4c8634 | Status: BLOCKED_BY_RESEARCH_GAP